Taoism

Key Ideas

Wuwei 无为 — acting without forcing, and letting things flow.

Yin and Yang 阴阳 — two opposite forces that balance each other.

Dao 道 — the way; the natural order behind everything.

De 德 — the quiet power you gain by following the Dao.

Nature 自然 — the world as it is, not as we plan it to be.

Simplicity 朴素 — wanting less, and living with less.

Harmony 和谐 — moving with things, not against them.

Inverse 反 — things often turn into their opposites.

Famous Quotes

The journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step.

Be simply yourself, stop comparing, and people will respect you.

Nature does not hurry, yet everything is accomplished.

Knowing others is intelligence; knowing yourself is true wisdom.

Mastering others is strength; mastering yourself is true power.

A good traveler has no fixed plans and is not intent on arriving.

He who knows that enough is enough will always have enough.

The best way to hold onto something is to let it go.

The flame that burns twice as bright burns half as long.

Happiness is the absence of the striving for happiness.

Discussion

What do you know about Taoism? Where did you first hear about it?

Which of these ideas do you already live by? Which would be the hardest?

"Go with the flow" — when has it worked for you, and when did it backfire?

Do you agree that wanting less brings more happiness? Give an example.

Your phone buzzes with 200 work messages — how would wuwei handle that?

Is there a time you forced a plan and regretted it? What happened?

A friend keeps comparing salaries and holidays. How would a Taoist reply?

Can simplicity survive in a city full of ads, deliveries and 24-hour shops?

Which quote would you save as your phone wallpaper, and why?

Should a leader control everything, or step back? Give a real example.

Taoism says softness beats hardness, like water on rock. Do you agree?

Has something you lost later turned out to be good? Tell us the story.

Would you rather live fast and bright, or slow and steady? Why?

Some people call Taoism lazy. How would you answer them?

In ten years, what would a simpler life look like for you?